



September 2026
50th Year of Growth
1976 - 2026



Contact Email: secretary@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Web Address: www.doncastergardenclubaus.com

The DGC committee meeting was held on 2nd September 2026 at 7.30 pm.
 The next DGC meeting will be held on **Wednesday, 9 September 2026**
 7.30 pm at the RSL Hall , cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street. Doors open at 7.15pm

Clare Harvey will present on the growing different varieties of Corn

Committee Members 2026

President
Avril Clark
 0402 478 302
president@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Vice-President & Speaker Bookings:
Vacant

Treasurer:
Dr Margaret Salter

Secretary:
Virgina Roberts & Connie Lee
secretary@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Fund Raising Co-Ordinator:
Anita Luzzia

Newsletter:
Rohini Padey
newseditor@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Reinhard
Esther Sim

Ray Brett

Welcome Spring !!!

There is a lot to look forward to in and around the garden this month. In this month's newsletter, you can read about the Q&A session last month and there are lots of useful gardening tips from our panel. There is a recipe for a very special cake, what to plant in the garden now, a visit to Reinhard's garden to see his composting projects and news from Pauline's very fruitful garden.

Running roughly through September and October in the Wurundjeri tradition, this period is named as Poorneet (Tadpole Season): this is marked by warming weather, blossoming flowers, and the life cycles of tadpoles.

*******50th Birthday Celebration *******

Please note that we have sent out invitations to the Birthday Celebration on 3rd October 2026.

Please could you respond to the email - let us know if you are joining in the celebration and also let us know if you have any dietary requirements.

Looking forward to celebrating our Garden Club with you all.

Doncaster Garden Club Subscriptions are due for renewal by the 31st October 2026

Please bring your returnable bottles and cans each month so we can collect the 10c deposit to add to the DGC financial reserve. (No squashed cans please)

August meeting - Question and Answer session

We had a very interactive session of Q&A with our very knowledgeable panel but the contributions from the audience also made for a great evening.

Our Panel comprised of - Rachel Maggiore qualified horticulturalist and owner of Seed Sensations Gardening Services, Carlos Semmens, organic vegetable grower who sells produce at Tunstall Square every Sunday, Esther Sim, committee member who has established a pretty and productive garden in pots, Pauline Webb – former club President and Doncaster Garden Club stalwart with a magnificent productive garden shared with club members on various open garden days

How to get your garden ready for spring - Getting the garden ready for spring starts around the 1st week in August. The panel all agreed that weeding takes place first and then adding compost to the soil. The panel talked about use of the no dig method which is on trend and that you do not disturb the microbiomes that are under the soil. Carlos says he follows the no dig method but sometimes does dig up the soil so that the compost can be mixed in. The panel shared their thoughts on what Compost they use. Pauline does a lot of composting and also has the Bokashi buckets and a worm farm. There are many types of compost you use but make sure it is from a good source. Read about Bokashi in the link below.

Companion Plants - We have a few speakers talk about companion plants to encourage good bugs that will keep the pests away. The plants that were recommended which are liked by beneficial bugs are Lavender, Marigold, Calendula, Nasturtiums, Rosemary. The companion plants should be planted in the vegetable patch close to your plants so that the beneficial bugs can do their work. Plant chives around your roses to deter aphids. It was suggested that you could plant them in pots so you can move them around as needed.

Tips for Lawn care - To keep the lawn healthy the mower height should be adjusted for change of season, keep the lawn shorter in summer. Pauline recommends sprinkling gypsum of the lawn to help break down clay and spring is a good time to fork the lawn to aerate it. And of course some compost or top dressing soil will help the lawn. And it was recommended that we do not use feed and weed as it is harmful.

What to plant now - Already our panellists have sprouted tomato seeds inside or in the hot house and when the true leaves come through, the seedlings will be moved to a shady spot outside to be 'hardened' to the elements. Pauline has already transplanted her 12 day old seedlings into pots. She recommended leaving them in the greenhouse for a few more weeks as we have a few cold nights ahead.

Esther shared some of her tips - Add banana peels to water and let this sit for a couple of weeks. In a few weeks time you can dilute the banana tea and water your plants. She also uses rice water to feed her plants, she said the peace lily loves it. She grows a lot of her plants in pots and moves them around as needed, in and out of sun, shade.

Watch the video for information about Bokashi

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UF6HwJE96I0&t=226s>

Upcoming Calendar Events:

Upcoming Committee Meeting:	02 September	hosted by Virginia Roberts, 7.30pm
Upcoming Meeting:	09 September	at the RSL Hall, 7.30pm at cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street Doncaster East

Following Committee Meeting:	23 September	hosted by Avril Clark, 7.30pm at 62 Pine Hill Drive Doncaster East
Birthday Celebration	03 October	at the RSL Hall, 7.30pm at cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street Doncaster East

Exciting news! Our friends at the Ivanhoe Garden Club kindly invite all members of the DGC to join them on the IGC Bus trip. The itinerary for the IGC bus trip on Sunday, 11 October 2026 is as follows:

1. Werribee Rose Garden - morning tea
2. Wombat Gully Plant Farm, Moolap
3. Geelong Botanic Gardens - lunch
- Nursery will be open with plants for sale.
4. Cottage Farm Perennial Nursery and Gardens, Gnarwarre

The Cost: \$38

Start Time: 9 am

Bus pickup point: The Centre Ivanhoe (town hall), Upper Heidelberg Road, Ivanhoe.

IGC will provide further details (eg return time, toilet stops etc) about the day trip soon.

Please send an email to secretary@doncastergardenclubaus.com if you are interested in joining this trip and we will send you the details once we receive them.

Composting Project by Reinhard

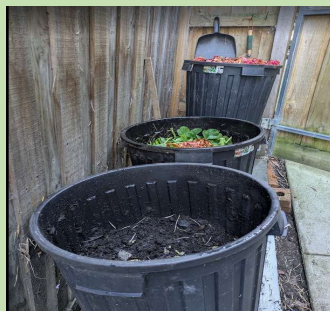
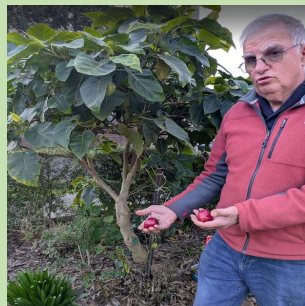
Reinhard is a serial composter and he has many interesting projects around his garden. I visited his productive garden to take some photos and understand a bit more about how these projects work. He has a productive garden in his front yard with roses, blueberries, tamarillos, bakchoy, leeks to name a few things.

He buries scraps into the ground, has some above ground compost bins and also has composted fish heads in the past (warning :only attempt this if you live on a large block and live with someone who has a blocked nose).

See below the pictures of how he makes holes in buckets(don't miss the picture of Reinhard posing with the bucket) then fills it with food scraps and leaves. He buries these buckets in his garden and the garden gnomes protect them till the compost is ready. The excess liquid drains into the plants around and they are thus receiving nutrition.

The first 3 pictures show you the steps on how he buries the scraps in the garden. The next 3 are of R showing his tamarillos, his above ground compost bins and blueberries.

I am sure he can share more details with you if are interested, do approach him at the meeting with questions if any.



Hello Gardeners All

The ground is still wet and there's another 5 days of showers predicted which will arrive by the time you receive this. The temperature is warm enough for the grass to grow so the mowing is needing to be regular.

The suburb has wattle trees and flowering peach in bloom which is attractive and cheerful. Many trees are commencing their first hint of leaf - a greenish haze as shoots fatten branches. In my garden the camelias are still lingering. I'm impatiently waiting to prune them back from paths.

My tête à tête daffodils are flowering beautifully if members wish to drive by, step out of the car and into my drive where they will see them on the left side.

The plum and apricot trees have a couple of flowers out so spring is almost here. Both were pruned hard (I can highly recommend our member Rachel) so may not have much crop this year. They are elderly and were too big.

I noticed that a 7yr bean is already shooting. It's ok as long as there's no late frost. The snap peas are producing small amounts regularly and there are plenty of flowers for more. The Silverbeet is growing faster now and I am allowing the last of the bok choy to flower for the good insects. It is still too cool for the bees.

The beetroot did not grow decent beets. I try each season but it's one veg I am still working with.

There are beds needing top dressing and feeding but until they dry out better and there is some consistent warmth, it is still a little early. I'm an impatient gardener as we come into changing seasons. However, I still have 2 roses to prune so that needs thinking on.

Trevor has been adding the constant collection of fallen camelia blooms to the compost pile with mulched prunings off trees and the grass clippings. It will be ready by mid summer for top dressing beds.

Until Next time, Happy Gardening Pauline

ARMENIAN NUTMEG CAKE

Virgina had baked this delicious cake for our meeting last week. This recipe was handed down to her from her mother. Do try to bake this cake and let us know how you like it.

Ingredients

- 1 cup self-raising flour
- 1 cup plain flour
- 1 teaspoon ground nutmeg
- 125 gram butter
- 1 1/2 cup brown sugar
- 1 teaspoon bicarbonate of soda (baking soda)
- 1 cup milk
- 1 egg
- 1/2 cup chopped walnuts or pecans



Method

1. Grease 20cm x 30cm lamington pan.
2. Sift flours and nutmeg into large bowl; rub in butter, mix in sugar (or process until crumbly). Press 1 ½ cups of this mixture into prepared pan.
3. Stir combined soda and milk into remaining dry ingredients with egg and nuts, mix well; pour into prepared pan.
4. Bake in moderate oven about 35 minutes. Stand 5 minutes before turning onto wire rack to cool.

Brunch at Heidi Café

How to spend a perfect Sunday - brunch at Heide Kitchen with good company, followed by a walk in the free sculpture park and garden!

On 29 August 2026, Ron Thomson, Tracey Mitchell, John Murphy, Robyn Wilson and I enjoyed a lovely brunch at Heide Kitchen. The food was yummy, garnished with fresh garden herbs and edible flowers (I had the signature rosti benedict, ☺). It was a perfect day as we wandered through the vegetable garden, with an abundance of vegetables as evidence of the Heide garden-to-plate ethos.

by Connie lee



What seeds to plant in September				
Cucurbits	Other warm season	Leafy greens	Roots	Other veggies
Cucumber	Basil	Lettuce	Beetroot	Asparagus
Gourd	Beans	Mizuna	Carrot	Celery
Pumpkin	Capsicum	Mustard greens	Jerusalem artichoke	Chives
Rockmelon	Chilli	Parsley	Onion	Coriander
Watermelon	Eggplant	Rocket	Parsnip	Globe artichoke
Zucchini	Sweetcorn	Silverbeet	Potato	Leeks
	Tomatoes	Radish spring Onions	Rhubarb	

Article From LFC News August 26 (see the planting guide for more detail):



Hello Gardeners,

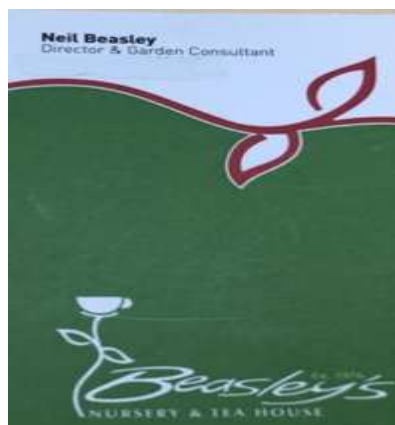
Here is an invitation from the Arthurs Creek Garden Walk community - We would love to invite you and your fellow garden lovers to the 38th Annual Arthurs Creek Garden Walk, being held on Sunday 25 October 2026.

Now in its 38th year, the Arthurs Creek Garden Walk is a wonderful day out in the beautiful Arthurs Creek district, bringing together gardeners, plant lovers and the local community. Along with the opportunity to explore some wonderful local gardens, there will be plants for sale, morning and afternoon tea, a light lunch, displays, art, craft, garden sculpture, Landcare and more.

Tickets available from 9:30am–3:00pm at Arthurs Creek Hall. Garden is open till 5pm.



DGC Life Members	
Gerda van der Peet Doug Brewer Gayle McCann Ted Page	Joanne Driver Elsie Carter Bev Turner Franziska Kung



The Ryset Catalogue can be found online:

<https://ryset.com>

The Club receives wholesale prices which means discounts of up to 60-70%



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